

Project Specs and Risk Assessment Doc

Required Components

Title page (see {15} for details)

- Include your group number (e.g., 2026.75), student details (names, IDs, email addresses), name of consultant.

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Section 2: Project Specifications

For your document:

- Write the specs in table form with additional text as needed.
- Label each specification as essential or non-essential.
- Each spec must be verifiable.
- Each spec is appropriate.
- The set of specs is complete.
- Specs are open-ended.

Open-ended: The spec may be designed/implemented in several ways.

Section 1: High-Level Description of Project

1.3 Block Diagram

- A block diagram provides a “big picture” description of your project.
- It should be well labelled, showing the project's inputs, subsystems, and outputs. Aim for 4-6 subsystems.

References

- Use IEEE formatting, and number references as [1], [2], etc.
- Be sure to properly reference any figures taken from other sources.

Example:

Writing Style, Page Limit, Font Size, Font Spacing, Margins, Printing and Binding

Follow the instructions for the Project Specifications and Risk Assessment submission (see [page 15](#)), except the page limit for the Detailed Design and Project Timeline document is **30 pages**, including everything (title page, table of contents, ..., references, optional appendices).

Exception to line spacing requirement: Single-line spacing may be used for the Table of Contents and References.

Note that almost all the documents should be written in present tense (e.g., use “Power for the circuit is provided via connector A.” instead of “Power for the circuit will be provided via connector A.”).

Required Components of the Detailed Design and Project Timeline Document *

Component	Comments
Title page	Include on the title page: - the university, Faculty, and department names (University of Waterloo, Faculty of Engineering, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering) - your project title and your group number - a list of the group members, including student numbers - the name of your consultant - the submission date
Table of Contents	Include a Table of Contents on a separate page. Number all pages after the title page.

Writing Style

This deliverable is a formal technical document. Hence, use formal language throughout. Use a professional-looking font and layout throughout. Standard technical writing habits should be followed:

- units of measurement (e.g., “m” for meters, “V” for volts) should be indicated for every numeric quantity
- acronyms and jargon should be defined the first time they are used
- each figure should have a number and caption below it, and each figure should be cited in text
- each table should have a number and caption above it, and each table should be cited in text
- figure/table numbering should be consistent in the report body
- for figures/tables taken from another source, cite that source by reference number in the caption
- all figures/tables should appear in the report close to where they are first cited in the main body
- all figures/tables must be readable and should not be split over multiple pages if possible
- each reference (in the References section) should be cited at least once in the report body.

In addition, pay attention to structure and flow, as well as sentence and paragraph structure. Use acronyms and jargon sparingly. Spelling and grammar should be correct. Writing quality is very important: you might have the greatest design project in the class, but if you do not explain effectively and efficiently what you have done, the reader will not appreciate, and possibly not even understand, what your project is about.

Throughout your writing, keep in mind that the course instructor does not have expertise in every subfield of electrical and computer engineering. Hence, if the scope of your project is very different from his expertise, you would be wise to take extra care in minimizing jargon and explaining specialized background. Feel free to ask the instructor how knowledgeable he is with your project area.

Before writing anything, you should carefully study the marking sheets/rubrics.

Page Limit, Font Size, Font Spacing, and Margins

To encourage you to be concise, and to keep the marking load on the course instructor realistic, the page limit is **10 pages**, including everything (title page, table of contents, ..., references).

To maximize readability of your report, please use an 11 or 12 point font and 1.15 to 1.50 line spacing, with at least 1-inch (2.54 cm) margins on all edges; use at least a 9 point font for words that appear in figures. Any standard professional-looking font is acceptable.